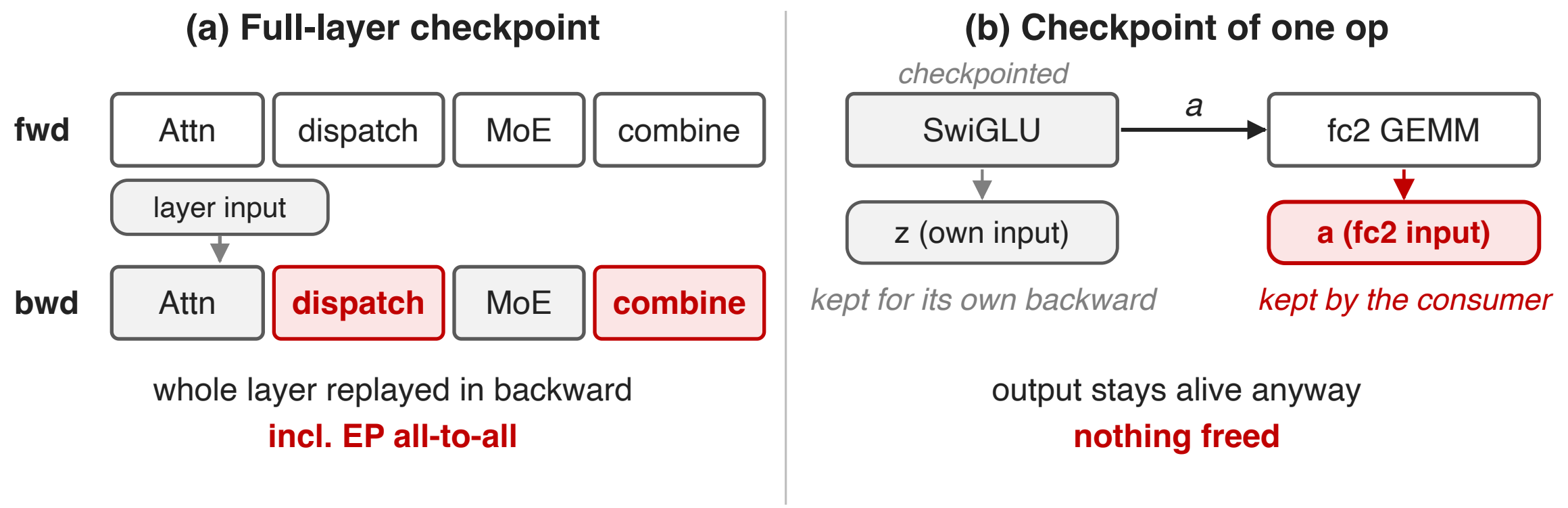

(a) Full-layer checkpoint
fwd
Attn
dispatch
MoE
combine
layer input
bwd
Attn
dispatch
MoE
combine
whole layer replayed in backward
incl. EP all-to-all
(b) Checkpoint of one op
checkpointed
SwiGLU
a
fc2 GEMM
z (own input)
a (fc2 input)
kept for its own backward
kept by the consumer
output stays alive anyway
nothing freed